

8.4 KEY LANGUAGE THE PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS

You use the past perfect continuous to describe an action or activity that was happening before another moment in the past.

He **had been learning** English for two years before he **went** to London.



TWO YEARS BEFORE

PAST

NOW



8.5 HOW TO FORM THE PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS

SUBJECT

"HAD"

"BEEN"

PRESENT PARTICIPLE

REST OF SENTENCE

He

had

been

learning

English for two years.



8.6 FILL IN THE GAPS BY PUTTING THE VERBS INTO THE PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS

They had been flying (fly) for ages, so she decided to walk around the aisles.

- 1 We _____ (wait) for at least an hour when the taxi finally arrived.
- 2 I eventually went to the pharmacy because I _____ (not feel) well for days.
- 3 We went to see the movie because they _____ (promote) it for months.
- 4 The streets were beautiful and white because it _____ (snow) all night.

